

HARNECIENT: Complete User Guide

Part 1: What You've Just Learned (Training Summary)

Welcome. Over the past 20 days, you've been learning the HARNECIENT way — a new approach to building systems where small language models become powerful tools through intelligent harnesses, not by pretending to be something they're not.

The Core Philosophy

Everything you need to know starts with this truth: **If it's not in a file, it's a lie.** We don't trust memory. We don't trust vibes. We write reality down, then prove it.

HARNECIENT is the practice of treating small models as text engines, not tool routers. A 270-million-parameter model from Ollama can't magically understand how to call your tools. But a harness around that text output can. We extract the patterns the model produces, we interpret them reliably, and we route them to the right action. The model provides the spark. We provide the work.

The 20 Days: A Quick Recap

Days 1-3: Foundations

Day 1: You learned what HARNECIENT means and why it matters

Day 2: You met the House itself — the livedesk taskbar, the 15-cell interface

Day 3: You learned about relays — plain text files that hold key presses

Days 4-5: The Hack

Day 4: The problem — small models hallucinate tool formats

Day 5: The solution — the HARNECIENT hack with five components

Days 6-7: Proof

Day 6: Never classify. Always describe

Day 7: We proved it works — even the tiny 270m model can edit code 9 for 9

Days 8-10: The Storefront

Day 8: H.AI — a single C file that renders a chat interface

Day 9: A four-phase plan to wire harnesses into the live model

Day 10: The taskbar is your interface to power

Days 11-13: The Harnesses

Day 11: The four laws of a living harness

Day 12: The code-tools harness

Day 13: Relay harnesses — the skeleton used everywhere

Days 14-15: The Masterclass

Day 14: How to prompt agents so they don't burn your tokens

Day 15: Every rule came from watching real sessions burn money

Days 16-20: The Product

Day 16: Events — games are, at their core, events

Day 17: The database is not a black box

Day 18: Everything so far exists for the games

Day 19: A window into the near future

Day 20: The vision — a factory agents and humans can both operate

The Nautilus Spiral

The same logic applies at every scale. A galaxy contains solar systems. A chest contains gold. The rules are identical. That's the Harnecient pattern: $\phi = 1.618$. The spiral continues.

Part 2: Installing HARNECIENT (Your System)

What You're Installing

HARNECIENT is not software you download. It's a practice built on:

1. **Livedesk** — the 15-cell interface where everything runs
2. **TPMOS** — the Piece Method Operating System, where files are reality
3. **Relay harnesses** — text-based scripting that drives behavior
4. **Small models** — Ollama-compatible models
5. **Your games** — structured event files

Installation: Step-by-Step

Step 1: Prepare Your System

You need:

- A Linux machine (Windows support coming soon)
- Bash shell
- About 2GB of free disk space
- An Ollama instance running

Check if you have the installer:

```
ls -la ~/xyz-installer-dev/xyzos-starter-install.sh
```

Step 2: Run the Installer

The installer is non-destructive. It will refuse to run if you already have a `~/xyzos` directory.

```
bash ~/xyz-installer-dev/xyzos-starter-install.sh
```

The installer will:

- Read from the dev tree (never writes to it)
- Create a fresh `~/xyzos/` directory
- Copy the login and avatar apps
- Compile them
- Set up paths
- Create a launcher script

Step 3: Verify the Installation

```
ls ~/xyzos/
```

You should see: `apps/` , `app-store/` , `xyzfs/` , `button.sh` , `paths.pdl`

Step 4: Boot for the First Time

```
~/xyzos/button.sh
```

You'll see: `Not logged in.` This is correct. The system is waiting for you to create an account.

| Part 3: Using HARNECIENT

Creating Your Account

1. You'll see: A prompt asking for "User ID"
2. Type: A username you want (e.g., `alice`)

3. Press: Enter
4. You'll see: A prompt for "Display Name"
5. Type: How you want to appear (e.g., `Alice`)
6. Press: Enter
7. Button: Select "Create Account"

The system will generate a unique UUID, create your profile, create your private home, and log you in.

Understanding Your File System (xyzfs)

Everything you own lives in one place:

```
~/xyzos/xyzfs/users/<your-uuid>/
```

Inside that directory:

- `meta.txt` — metadata about you
- `home/` — your home directory
- `projects/` — where you build games
- `saves/` — where you save game progress

Creating Your First Game

Games are event files. A basic game structure looks like:

SECTION	KEY	VALUE
META	piece_id	my_first_game
META	version	1.0
EVENTS	start	welcome_message
EVENTS	choice_a	go_north
EVENTS	choice_b	go_south
WELCOME	text	Welcome to my game. Go north or south

WELCOME	choices	North South
NORTH	text	You found treasure!
NORTH	end	true
SOUTH	text	You found danger!
SOUTH	end	true

To create your first game:

1. Create a new file: `~/xyzos/xyzfs/users/<uuid>/projects/my_game.pdl`
2. Write your event structure
3. Save the file
4. Boot the system
5. Look in your projects directory
6. Select "Play"
7. See your game come to life

Playing a Game

1. Boot the system: `~/xyzos/button.sh`
2. Log in with your account
3. Look for the game in your home
4. Select "Play"
5. Follow the prompts the game designer created

Backing Up Your Games

Because everything is files, backing up is simple:

```
cp -r ~/xyzos/xyzfs/users/<your-uuid>/ ~/backups/my-xyzos-backup-$(date)
```

Part 4: Philosophy for Game Makers

When you build a game in HARNECIENT, remember:

1. **State is a file.** If it's not written to disk, it doesn't exist.
2. **Events are atomic.** One event = one choice point or outcome.
3. **Players are explorers.** Design so they can inspect files and understand the logic.
4. **Simplicity wins.** Make events punchy.
5. **The Nautilus Spiral applies.** A small game can nest inside a large one.

Part 5: Next Steps

You now understand:

- How HARNECIENT works (20 days of training)
- How to install it (5 minutes)
- How to use it (create accounts, play games, make games)
- How to share it (copy files)

What to do next:

1. Install the system on your machine
2. Create your first account
3. Create a small test game (3-5 events)
4. Play it yourself
5. Invite someone to play
6. Build bigger

Remember: If it's not in a file, it's a lie. Write it down. Then prove it works.

Appendix: File Locations Reference

What	Where
Install root	<code>~/xyzos/</code>
Your login app	<code>~/xyzos/apps/00.login-signup/</code>
Avatar app	<code>~/xyzos/apps/01.avatar-creation /</code>
Your home	<code>~/xyzos/xyzfs/users/<uuid>/home/</code>
Your projects	<code>~/xyzos/xyzfs/users/<uuid>/projects/</code>
Your saves	<code>~/xyzos/xyzfs/users/<uuid>/saves/</code>
Path map	<code>~/xyzos/paths.pdl</code>
Installed apps	<code>~/xyzos/app-store/installed_apps.pdl</code>
Current login	<code>~/xyzos/apps/00.login-signup/current_login.txt</code>
Account records	<code>~/xyzos/apps/00.login-signup/users/<username>/profile.txt</code>

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